❖ Precipitation

The water droplets join together to form clouds. As they get cooler, the droplets become bigger and heavier and fall as rain. If the air is very cold, they freeze to fall as hail of snow.

❖ Flowing back to Oceans

Rain water forms streams and springs which join together to form rivers. Rivers flow finally into the sea and ocean thereby completing the cycle.



Do you know?

In freezing conditions, water falling from the sky becomes snow or hail. Hail stones are balls of ice.



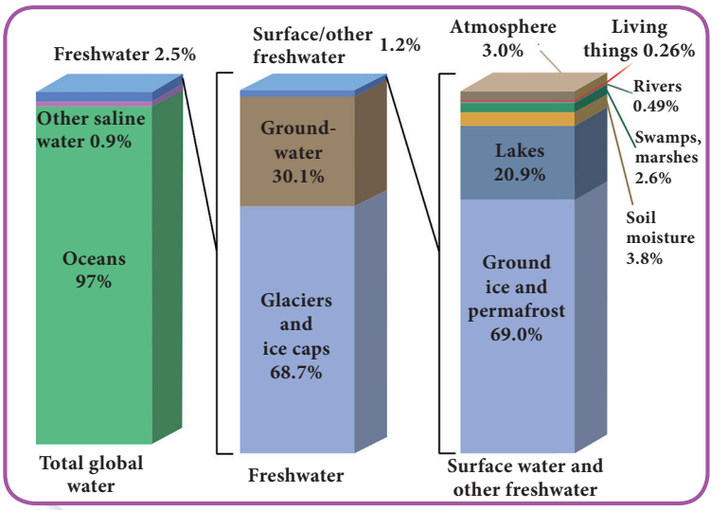
Activity 1

Take half a glass of water. Clean the outside part of the glass. Add few ice cubes and leave it for 5-10 minutes. You will observe drops of water appearing outside the glass. This happens because the water vapour in the air condenses on the cold surface of the glass.



III. Water Management

About 97.5% of total water available on the earth is too salty to be used for drinking and irrigation. The rest 2.5% of water is fresh water. Most of the fresh water i.e., 68.7% of the total fresh water is frozen as ice caps and glaciers and 30.1% occurs as ground water. Out of the remaining 1.2% of water, about 0.9% occurs as moisture in soil, air and in bodies of living organisms. The rest 0.3% constitutes fresh surface water sources, such as rivers and lakes. By this it is clear that a very small fraction of water is available for the use of human beings, animals and plants. The following figure shows the percentage distribution of total available water.





Do you know?

Agriculture is the source of our living. It uses most of the world's fresh water resources. It consumes around 70% of the available fresh water.

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